

CSCI 1470

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Friday,
1/24/25

Deep Learning

Day 2: Machine Learning Fundamentals

What do you want to get out of the Class?

- Understanding Applications and Real-World Implementation (36.8% of responses)
- Theoretical Understanding of Deep Learning (why it works) (35.4% of responses)
- Career Development (a job) (28.5% of responses)
- Practical Programming Skills (22.9% of responses)
- Domain-Specific Applications (5.6% of responses)

What do you want to get out of the Class?

- Additional notable patterns:
 - Interest in understanding both the **theoretical and practical** aspects together
 - Understand **modern AI technologies** better, especially in light of recent developments
 - **Independent projects** and gaining the confidence to implement systems without supervision
 - Interest in **ethical considerations and societal impacts** of deep learning

What do you wish your professors knew about your experiences as a student?

1. Course Organization and Support (37.3% of responses)
 1. Access to resources/TAs, clear deadlines and expectations, etc.
2. Background and Experience Variation (23.0% of responses)
 2. For some people, this is their first course in Python
 3. For many students, this is their first course in AI
 4. Just because you've taken linear algebra doesn't mean you remember anything
3. Workload and Time Management (15.1% of responses)
 3. Students are stressed, especially around exam weeks
4. Learning Preferences and Styles (12.7% of responses)
 4. Many students prefer project-based learning
5. Career and Future Goals (6.3% of responses)
 5. Internship/job interviews can cause conflicts
 6. Goal of your education is to get a job after and want to work towards that goal
6. Accessibility Needs (4.0% of responses)

What do you want to get out of the Class?

- A seat...

Any pending override approvals not accepted by 5pm today will be revoked and new overrides will be given out.

Recap: Machine Learning

Input: X



Function: f



Output: Y

"Cooking?"



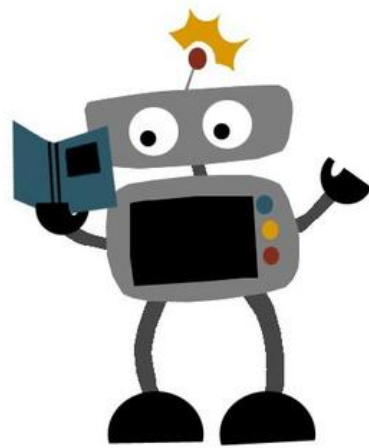
$f(X) \rightarrow Y$



Today's Goals

- 1) How do we represent Input/Output? What are X and y ?
- 2) How can we learn a function f ?
- 3) How do you know if a ML model is “Good”?

How do we represent Input/Output?



Input: X



Computers work
with numbers!

Output: Y

"Cooking?"



How can we represent
output labels as numbers?



Function: f



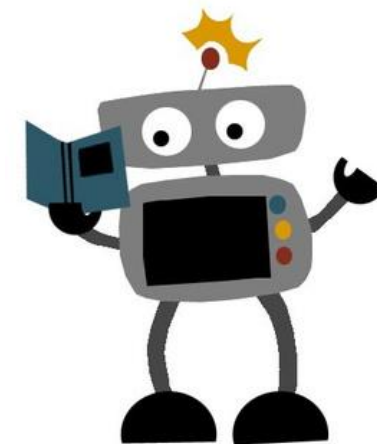
$f(X) \rightarrow Y$



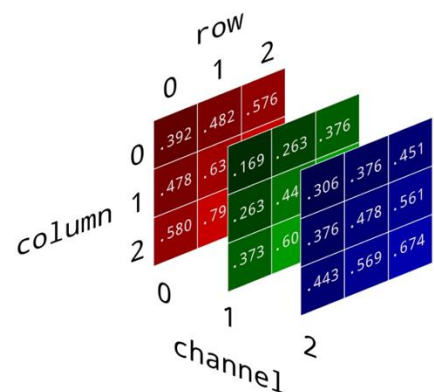
How can we represent
Input with numbers?



How do we represent Input/Output?



Input: X



Output: Y

"Cooking?"



1

0

Function: f

$$f(X) \rightarrow Y$$

$$y \in \{0,1\}$$

$$X \in \mathbb{R}^{H \times W \times 3}$$

Classification

When y is discrete, the task is **classification**

Input: X



Output: Y

"Cooking?"



When $y \in \{0, 1\}$ the task is **Binary Classification**



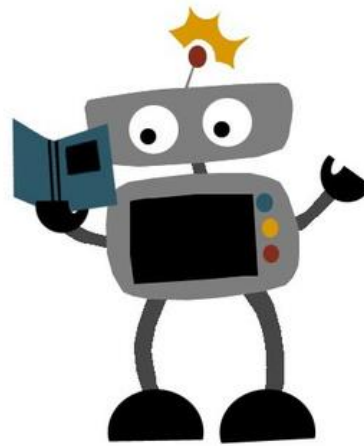
Function: f



What's an example of **multi-class Classification**?



$f(X) \rightarrow Y$



Some Notation

$\mathbb{R}$: The set of real numbers

$v \in \mathbb{R}^d$: A **vector** in dimension d

$V \in \mathbb{R}^{H \times W}$: A **matrix** of dimensions $H \times W$

$V \in \mathbb{R}^{H \times W \times C}$: A **tensor** of dimensions $H \times W \times C$

$\mathbb{X}$: A set of **input** data

$\mathbb{Y}$: A set of target variables (outputs/labels) for supervised learning

$x^{(k)}$: k 'th example (input) from dataset

$y^{(k)}$: k 'th example (output) associated with $x^{(k)}$

Simpler example: How do we represent input/output?



Input: $\mathbb{X}$

"Temperature"

$x^{(1)}$ 100.1 °F

$\mathbb{X} \in \mathbb{R}$

$x^{(2)}$ 80.0 °F

$x^{(3)}$ 30.3 °F

➡ Function: f ➡

Target: $\mathbb{Y}$

"Profit made on selling lemonade"

$y^{(1)}$ \$200.0

$y^{(2)}$ \$180.5

$y^{(3)}$ \$115.1

$\mathbb{Y} \in \mathbb{R}$

(Numerical output)



Learning function f



Input: $\mathbb{X}$
"Temperature"

$$x^{(1)} = 100.1$$

$$\mathbb{X} \in \mathbb{R}$$

$$x^{(2)} = 80.0$$

$$x^{(3)} = 30.3$$

➡ Function: f ➡

Step 1: Model Hypothesis:
What function do we think
best fits the data

Target: $\mathbb{Y}$

"Profit made on selling
lemonade"



$$y^{(1)} = 200.0$$

$$y^{(2)} = 180.5$$

$$y^{(3)} = 115.1$$

$$\mathbb{Y} \in \mathbb{R}$$

(Numerical output)

Learning function f



Input: $\mathbb{X}$
"Temperature"

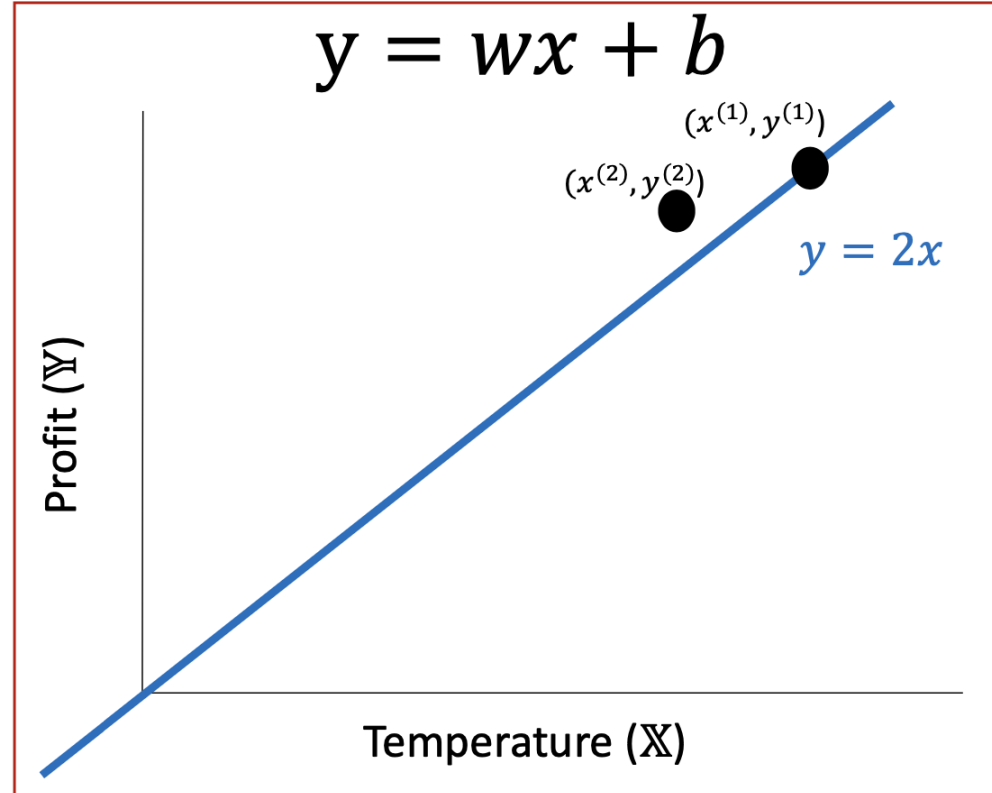
$$x^{(1)} = 100.1$$

$$x^{(2)} = 80.0$$

$$x^{(3)} = 30.3$$

$$\mathbb{X} \in \mathbb{R}$$

Linear function



Target: $\mathbb{Y}$

"Profit made on selling lemonade"



$$y^{(1)} = 200.0$$

$$y^{(2)} = 180.5$$

$$y^{(3)} = 115.1$$

$$\mathbb{Y} \in \mathbb{R}$$

(Numerical output)

Learning function f



Input: $\mathbb{X}$
"Temperature"

$$x^{(1)} = 100.1$$

$$x^{(2)} = 80.0$$

$$x^{(3)} = 20.2$$

$\mathbb{X} \in \mathbb{R}$

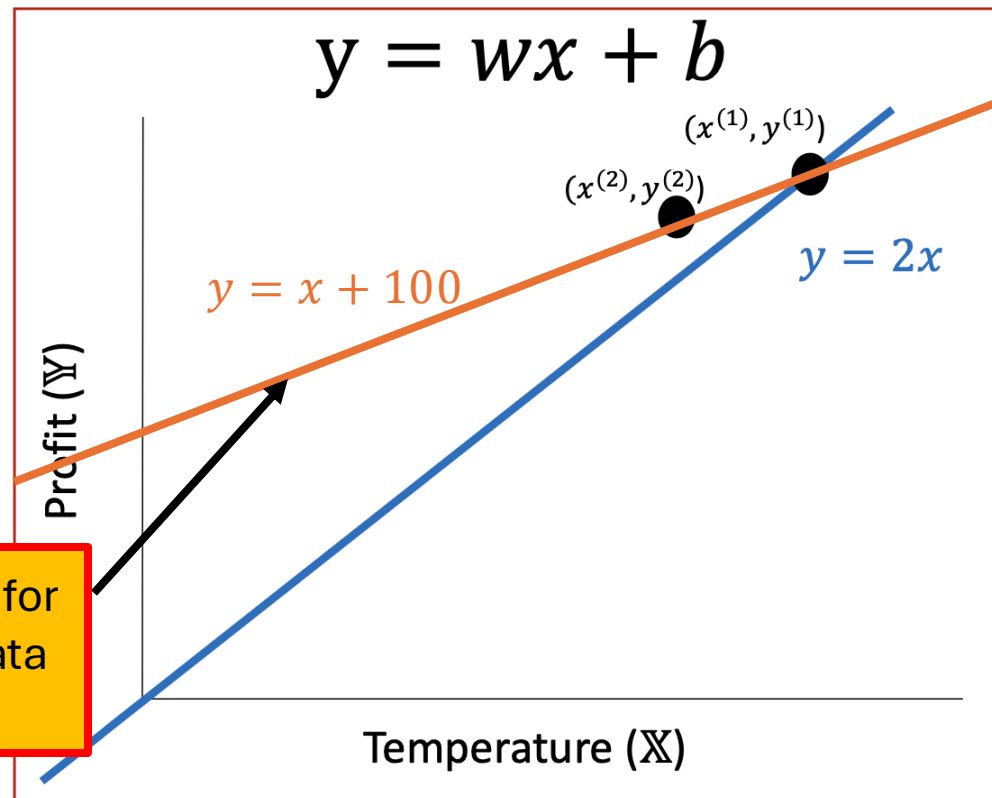
Target: $\mathbb{Y}$

"Profit made on selling lemonade"



Linear function

$$y = wx + b$$



$$y^{(1)} = 200.0$$

$$y^{(2)} = 180.5$$

$$y^{(3)} = 115.1$$

$\mathbb{Y} \in \mathbb{R}$
(Numerical output)

Bias term is necessary for
best fit line to fit the data
well

Learning function f



Input: $\mathbb{X}$
"Temperature"

$$x^{(1)} = 100.1$$

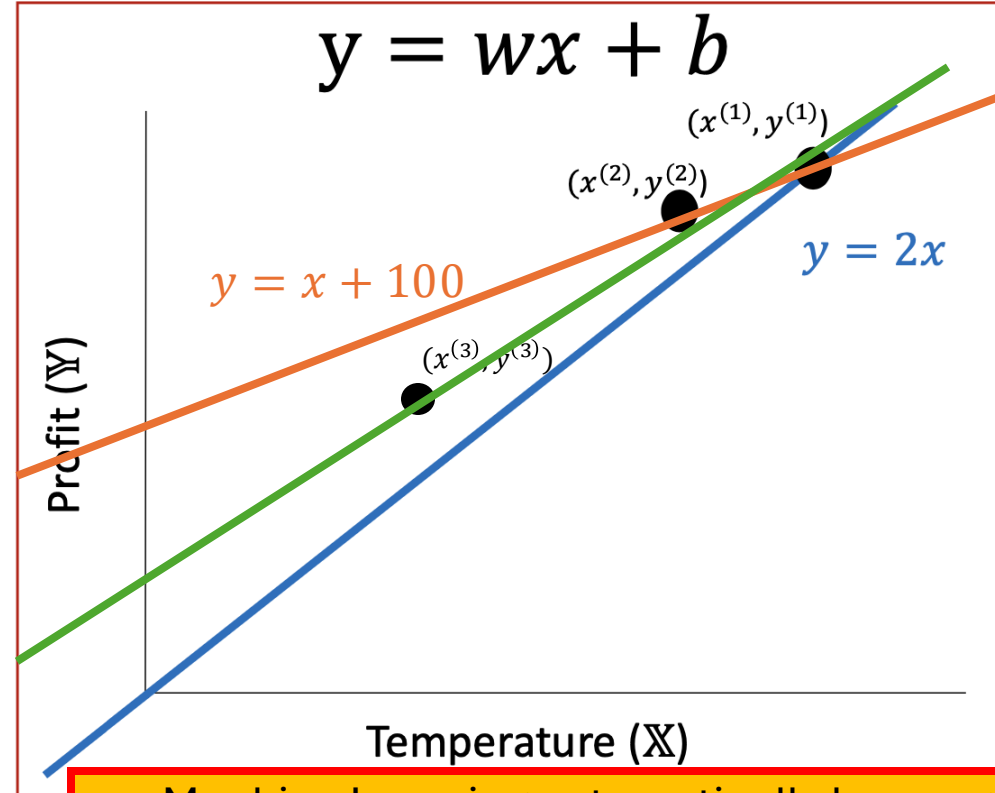
$\mathbb{X} \in \mathbb{R}$

$$x^{(2)} = 80.0$$

$$x^{(3)} = 30.3$$

Hard to find these
functions by hand...

Linear function



Target: $\mathbb{Y}$

"Profit made on selling
lemonade"



$$y^{(1)} = 200.0$$

$$y^{(2)} = 180.5$$

$$y^{(3)} = 115.1$$

$\mathbb{Y} \in \mathbb{R}$

(Numerical output)

Machine Learning automatically learns good
approximations of f from **data** (or at least tries to)

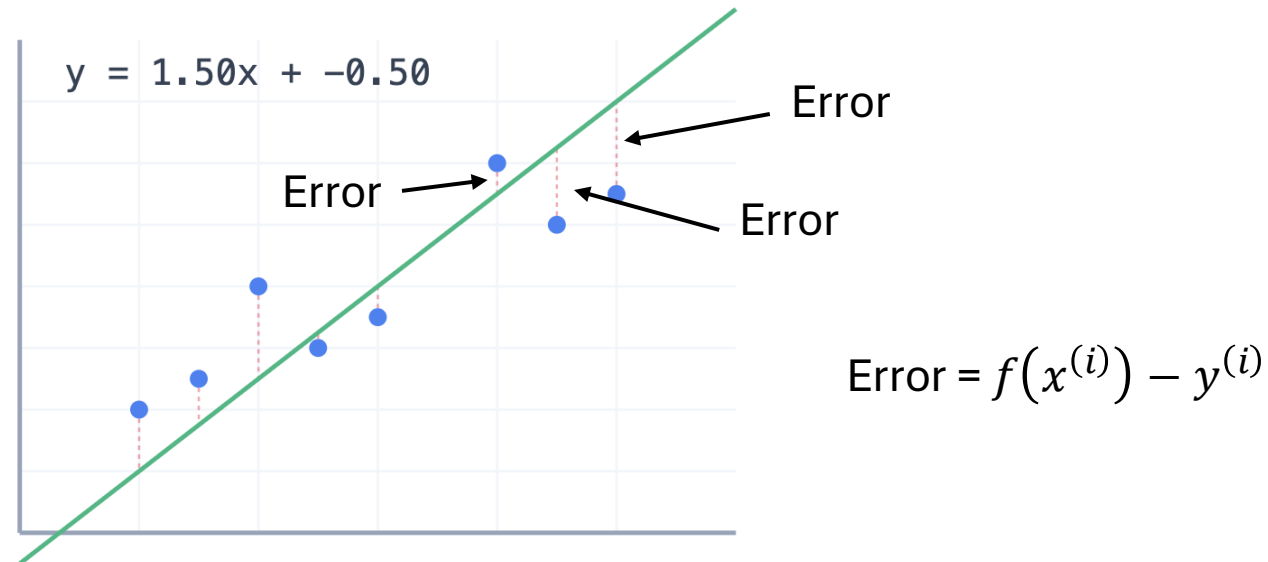
(Image only for explaining concept, not drawn accurately)

What makes a good approximation?

Loss Function: A function that describes how closely our approximation matches our data

The standard loss function for Linear Regression is **Mean Squared Error (MSE)**

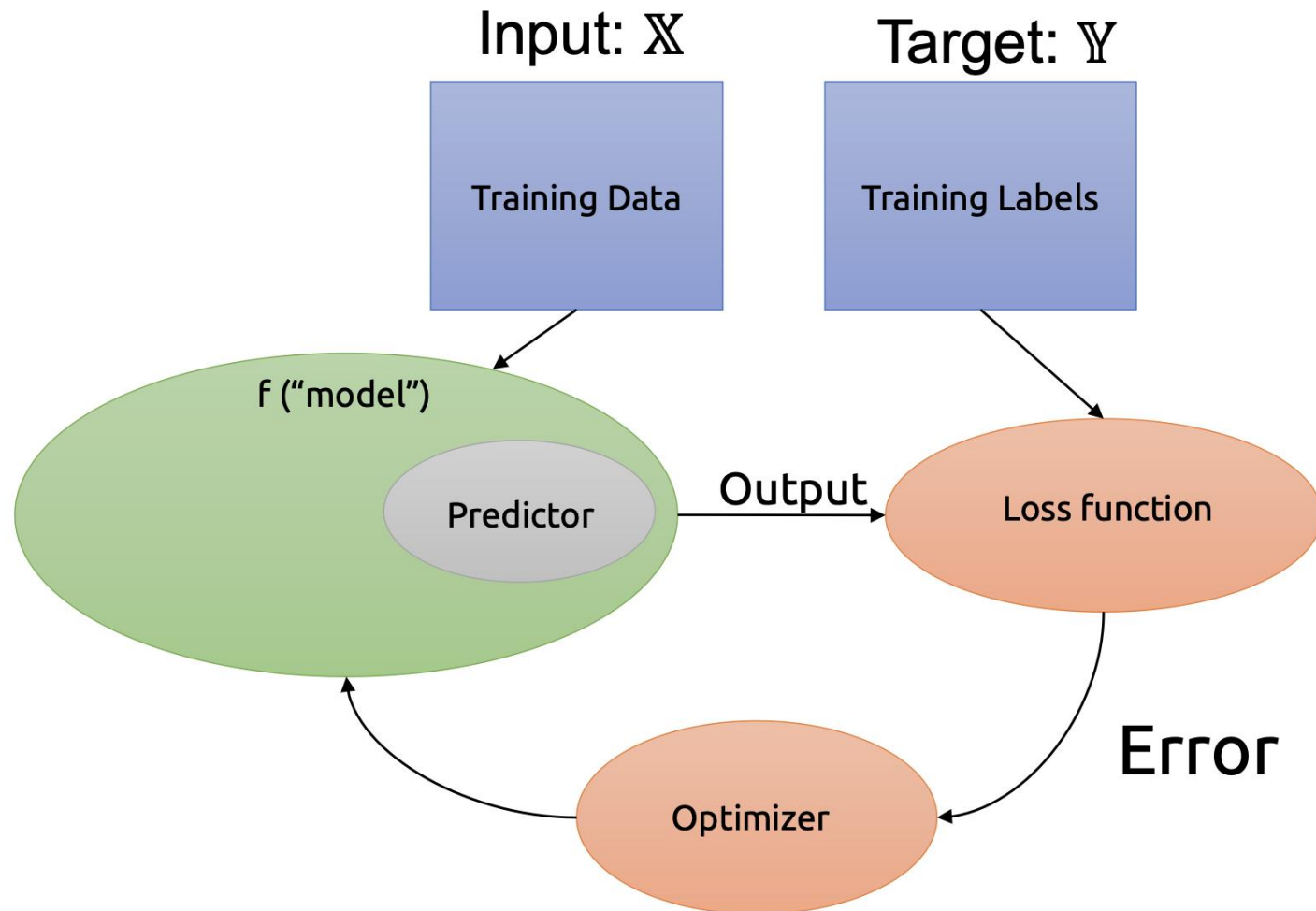
$$MSE = \frac{\sum_i^n (f(x^{(i)}) - y^{(i)})^2}{n}$$



What is the best approximation?

- <https://brown-deep-learning.github.io/dl-websites25/visualizations/visualizations.html>

“Classic” Supervised Learning in Machine Learning



Testing our model



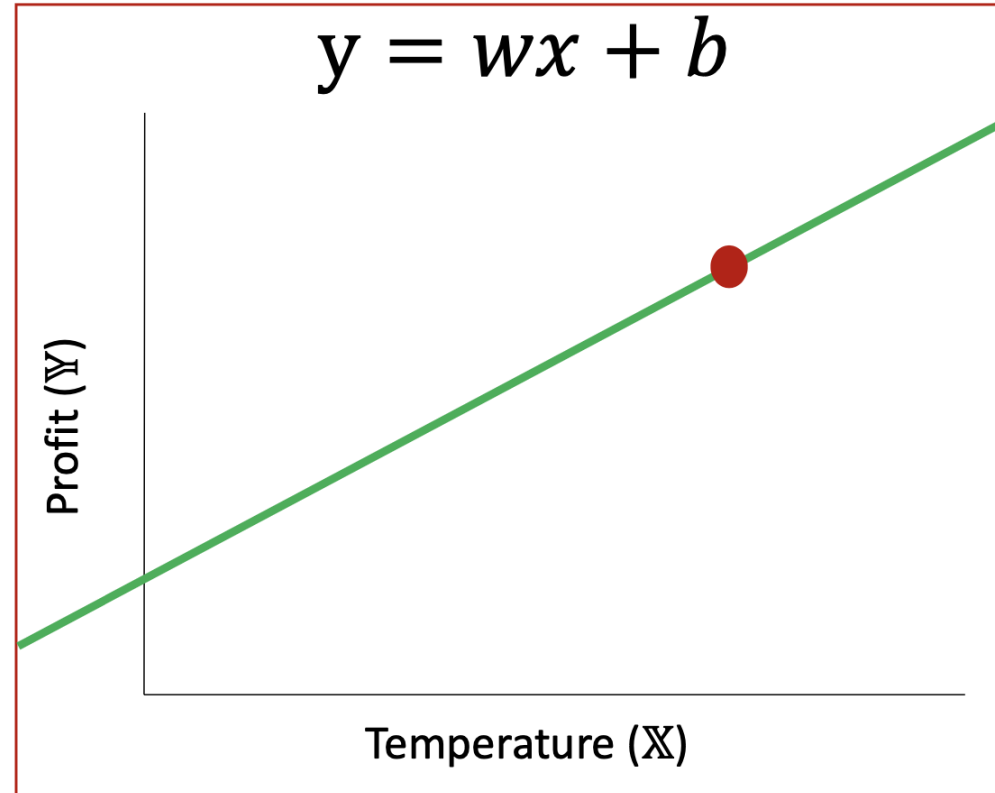
“Temperature”

$x' = 70$

Linear function

$$y = wx + b$$

“Profit made on selling lemonade”



Prediction

$y' = 175$

Testing our model



“Temperature”

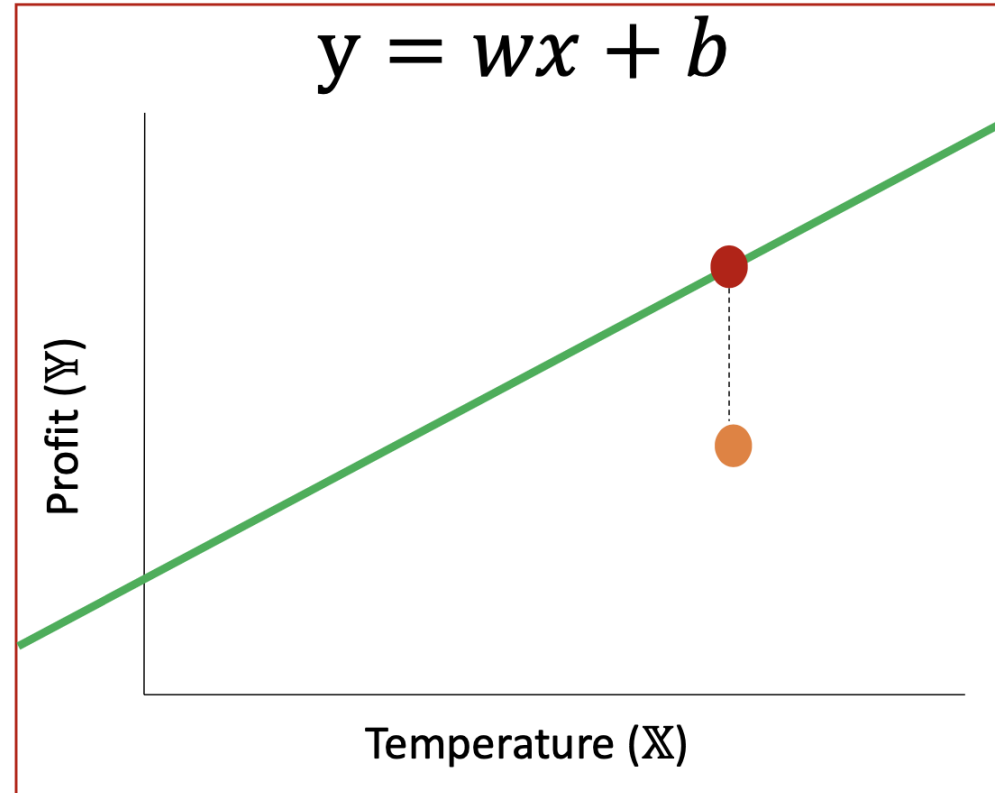
$$x' = 70$$

$$\hat{x} = 70$$

Linear function

$$y = wx + b$$

“Profit made on selling lemonade”



Prediction

$$y' = 175$$

True observation

$$\hat{y} = 140$$

Learning better models – Collect more data



Input: $\mathbb{X}$

“Temperature”

$$x^{(1)} = 100.1$$

$$x^{(2)} = 80.0$$

$$x^{(3)} = 30.3$$

⋮

⋮

⋮

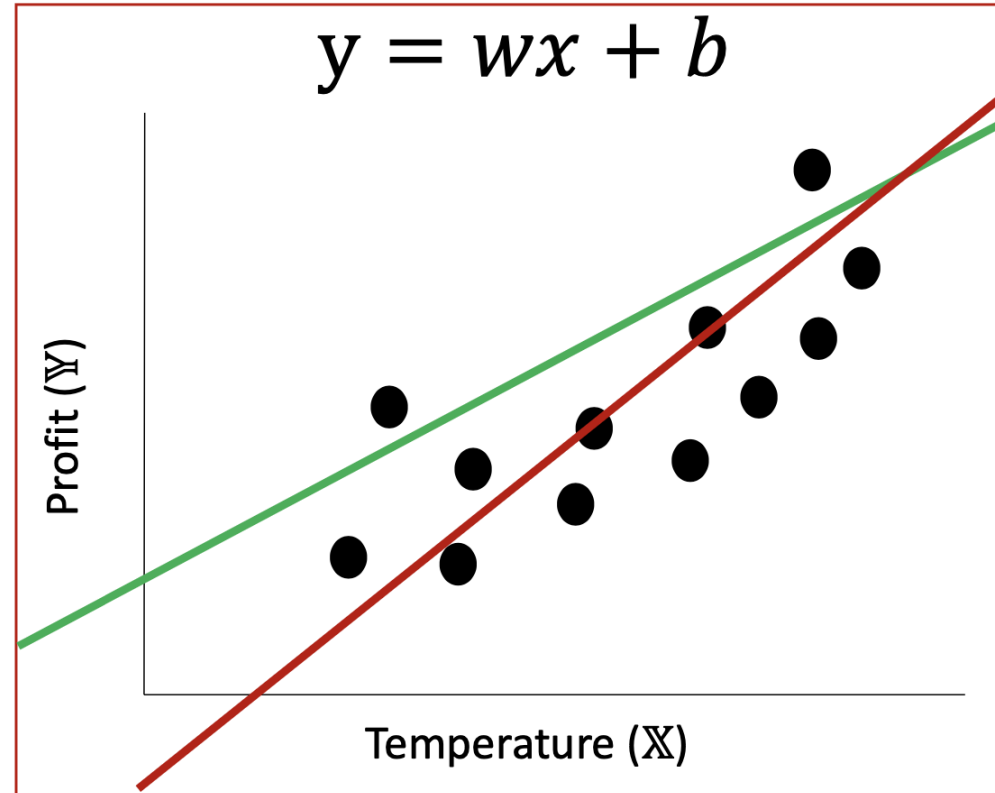
⋮

$$x^N = \dots$$

$$\mathbb{X} \in \mathbb{R}$$

Linear function

$$y = wx + b$$



Target: $\mathbb{Y}$

“Profit made on selling lemonade”

$$y^{(1)} = 200.0$$

$$y^{(2)} = 180.5$$

$$y^{(3)} = 115.1$$

⋮

⋮

⋮

⋮

$$y^N = \dots$$

$$\mathbb{Y} \in \mathbb{R}$$

(Numerical output)



(Image only for explaining concept, not drawn accurately)

Learning better models – Try different functions



Input: $\mathbb{X}$

“Temperature”

$$x^{(1)} = 100.1$$

$$x^{(2)} = 80.0$$

$$x^{(3)} = 30.3$$

⋮

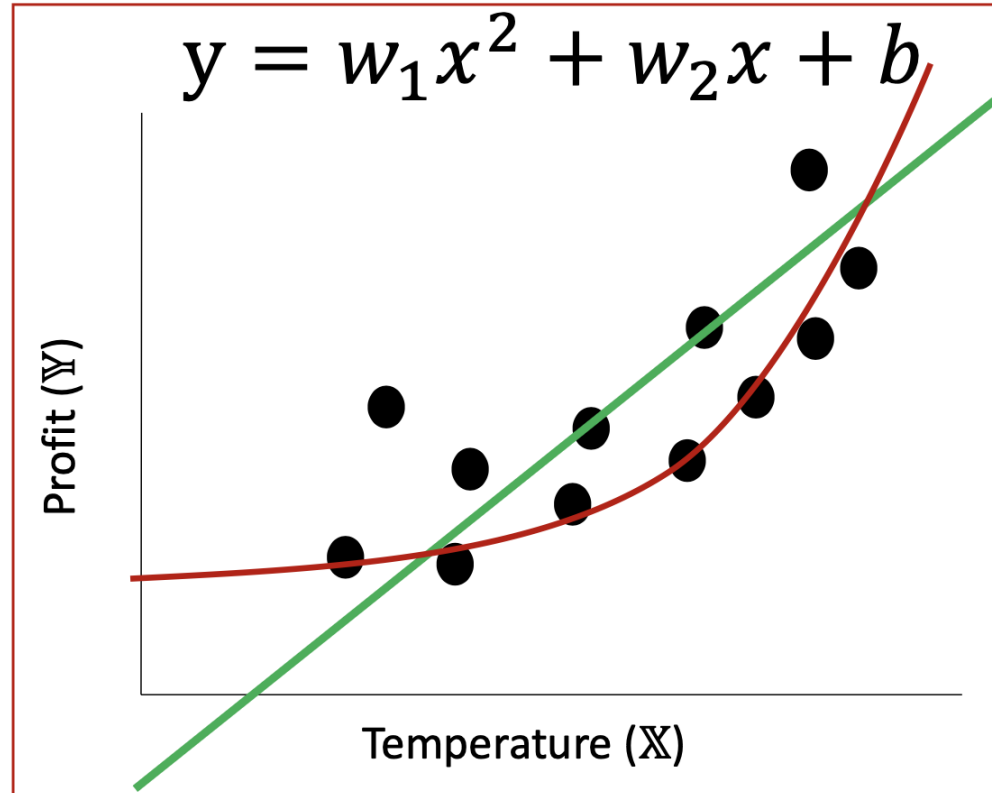
$$x^N = \dots$$

$$\mathbb{X} \in \mathbb{R}$$

Non-linear function

Polynomial function

$$y = w_1 x^2 + w_2 x + b$$



Target: $\mathbb{Y}$

“Profit made on selling lemonade”



$$y^{(1)} = 200.0$$

$$y^{(2)} = 180.5$$

$$y^{(3)} = 115.1$$

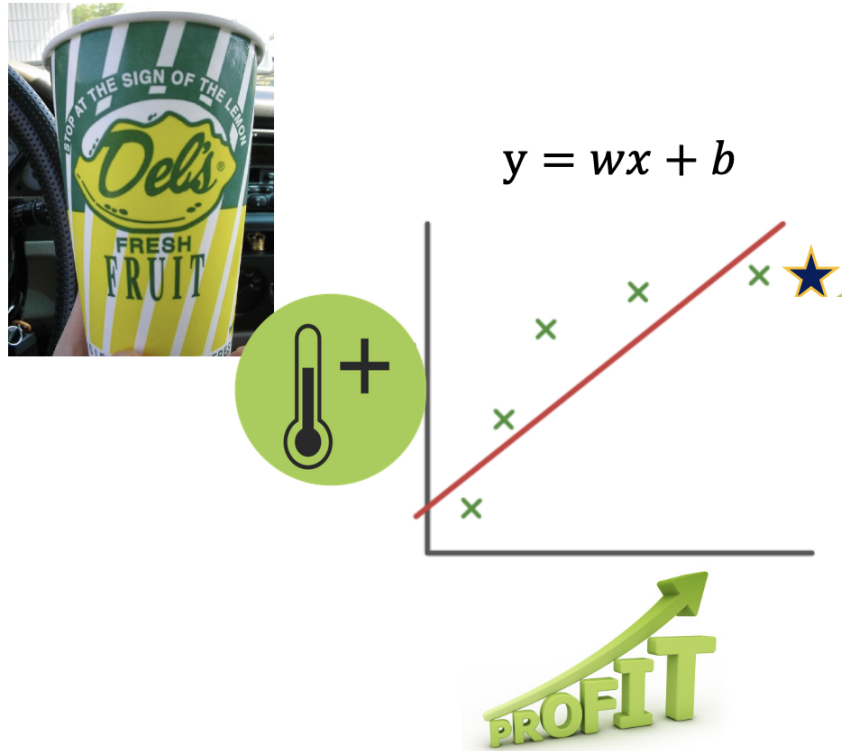
⋮

$$y^N = \dots$$

$$\mathbb{Y} \in \mathbb{R}$$

(Numerical output)

How to know which function is the best?



How to know which function is the best?

$\mathbb{X}$

$x^{(1)}$

$x^{(2)}$

$x^{(3)}$

$x^{(4)}$

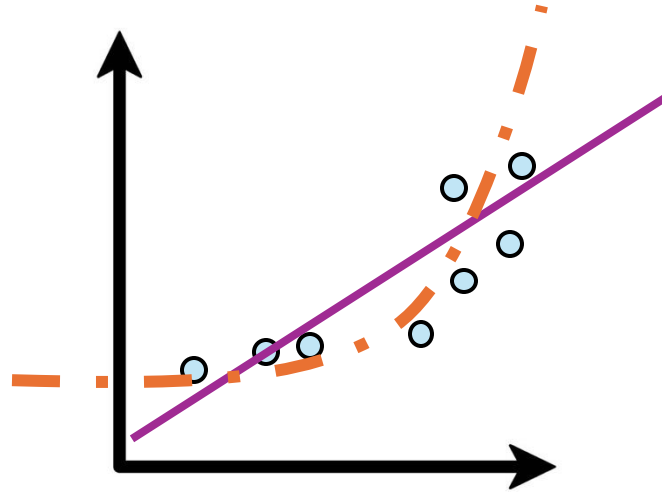
$x^{(5)}$

$x^{(6)}$

$x^{(7)}$

$x^{(8)}$

f_1 or f_2 ?



Compare MSE between
them?

How to know which function is the best?

$\mathbb{X}$

$x^{(1)}$

$x^{(2)}$

$x^{(3)}$

$x^{(4)}$

$x^{(5)}$

Training Set

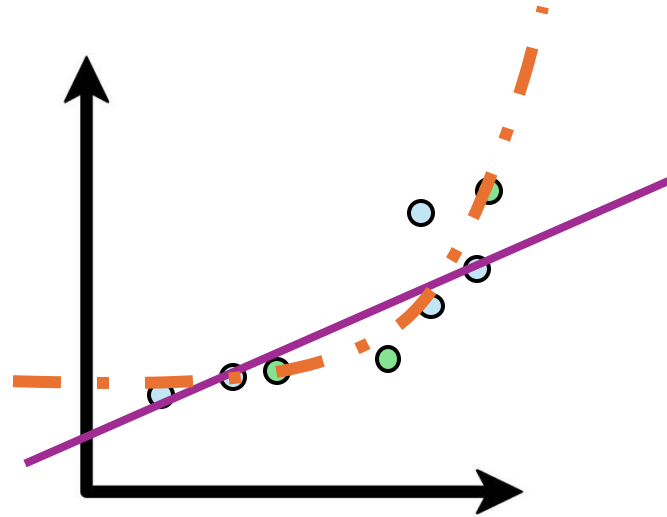
$x^{(6)}$

$x^{(7)}$

$x^{(8)}$

Test Set

f_1 or f_2 ?



Compare MSE on what data?

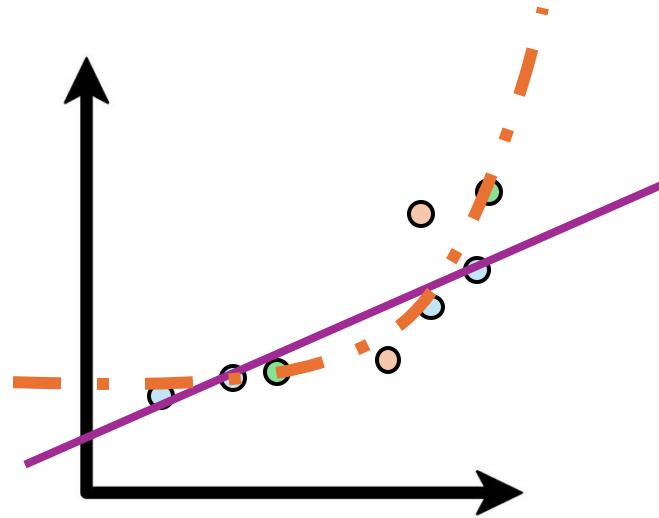
When might we want to overfit?

How to know which function is the best?

$\mathbb{X}$

$x^{(1)}$	Training Set
$x^{(2)}$	
$x^{(3)}$	
$x^{(4)}$	
$x^{(5)}$	Validation Set
$x^{(6)}$	
$x^{(7)}$	Test Set
$x^{(8)}$	

f_1 or f_2 ?



1. Train model on training set
2. Validate performance on validation set
3. Report results on test set

How to know which function is the best?

X

$x^{(1)}$

$x^{(2)}$

$x^{(3)}$

$x^{(4)}$

Training Set

$x^{(5)}$

$x^{(6)}$

Validation Set

$x^{(7)}$

$x^{(8)}$

Test Set

In this class

1. Train model on provided training data
2. Validate your model locally with validation set

Any questions? Hit to Gradescope and we have a separate test set



In real world

1. Train model on provided training data
2. Validate your model locally with validation set
3. Deploy your model to real world and track performance

Other ways to improve performance

Collect additional information

	x_1	x_2	x_3	y
	Temperature	Sunny?	Day of Week	Profit
$x^{(1)}$	90	Yes	Sat	\$200
$x^{(2)}$	80	No	Mon	\$91
$x^{(3)}$	62	No	Wed	\$54

How can we
represent binary
variables?

$$x_2^{(k)} \in \{0, 1\}$$

How can we
represent binary
variables?

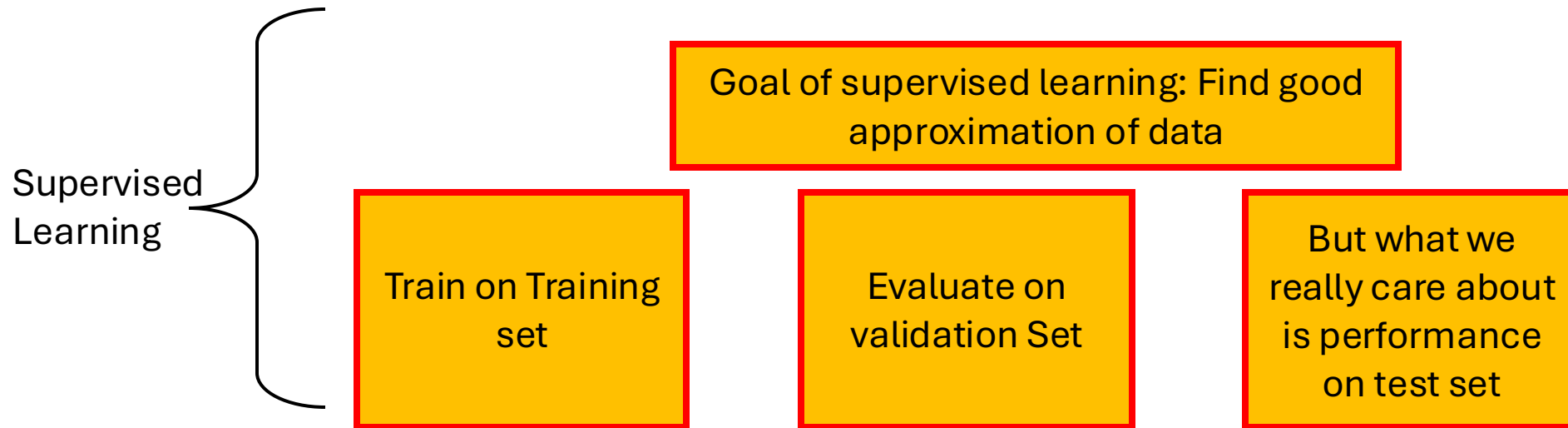
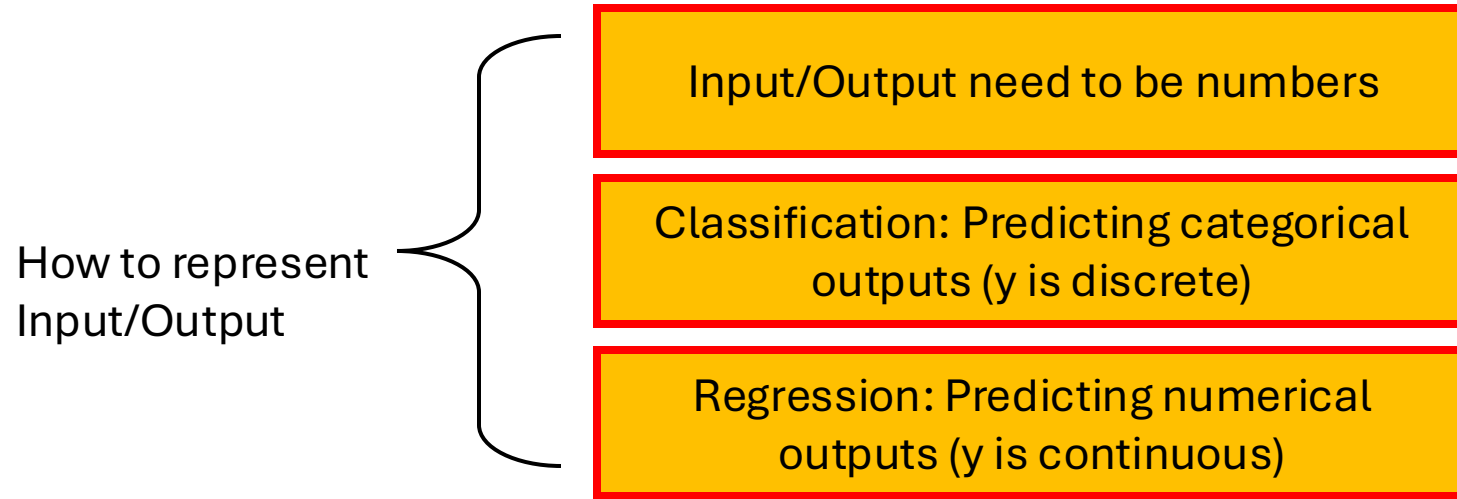
Idea 1: Mon=0, Tue=1, Wed.=2

The problem: Is Wednesday being 2x Tuesday meaningful?
Why use this ordering and not a random ordering?

Idea 2: Use a series of binary variables
If day==Mon, $x_4=1$, else 0
If day==Tue, $x_5=1$, else 0
...

“One-Hot Vector”: Turn
categorical variables into a
vector of binary variables

Key Ideas Review



Important Questions

- Linear Regression seeks to find a best fit function by minimizing MSE.
 - How can we find the **best** possible linear regression?
 - Are there **more than one** best fit line?
 - **Why did we choose MSE?** Why not Mean Error? Are there other loss functions that make sense?
- You can see how we can convert images to numbers, since pixels are stored as (r, g, b) values. But what about **other input types** like natural language? The protein for protein fold prediction? A chess board?